

Emergency Incident Command Document

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Purpose

This document outlines the expectations and requirements for emergency preparedness as per the CMS Emergency Preparedness Final Rule and E-Tag guidelines. It serves as a guide for establishing an Emergency Incident Command structure and ensuring compliance with regulatory standards.

Key Elements of Emergency Preparedness

1. Emergency Preparedness Program

- **Comprehensive Approach:** Address health, safety, and security needs of the facility, staff, patients, and community.
- **Four Core Elements:**
 1. Emergency Plan based on a Risk Assessment.
 2. Policies and Procedures.
 3. Communication Plan.
 4. Training and Testing Program.

2. Definitions

- **Emergency:** A hazard impact requiring enhanced capacity and incident command processes.
- **Disaster:** A larger-scale hazard impact with outcomes below expectations despite enhanced capacity.

3. Survey Protocols

- Compliance assessed during initial, revalidation, recertification, and complaint surveys.
- Integration with Life Safety Code (LSC) surveys.

4. Incident Command Structure

- Establish a clear chain of command.
- Define roles and responsibilities for all staff.
- Ensure coordination with local emergency management agencies.

5. Communication Plan

- Maintain updated contact information for staff, patients, and emergency services.
- Establish protocols for internal and external communication during emergencies.

6. Training and Testing

- Conduct regular training sessions for staff on emergency procedures.
- Perform drills and exercises to test the effectiveness of the Emergency Plan.

Compliance with E-Tag Expectations

- Ensure all emergency preparedness activities align with E-Tag requirements.
- Document all training, testing, and updates to the Emergency Plan.

References

- CMS Emergency Preparedness Final Rule.
 - Appendix Z - Emergency Preparedness for All Provider and Certified Supplier Types.
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Implementation Checklist

- ☐ Develop and maintain an Emergency Plan.
 - ☐ Conduct a Risk Assessment.
 - ☐ Establish Policies and Procedures.
 - ☐ Create a Communication Plan.
 - ☐ Implement a Training and Testing Program.
 - ☐ Coordinate with local emergency management agencies.
 - ☐ Document all activities and updates.
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Roles and Responsibilities

- Clearly define the roles and responsibilities of each team member in the incident command structure.
 - Include specific tasks and decision-making authority.
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Communication Protocols

- Detail the chain of command and reporting lines.
 - Specify methods of communication (e.g., radios, phones).
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Emergency Scenarios

- Provide examples of specific emergency scenarios and the corresponding actions to be taken.
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Post-Incident Review

- Add a section for post-incident review and lessons learned to improve future responses.
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Document Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of Changes	Updated By
1.0	2026-05-18	Initial draft with updates.	